



AFP

tel in Cape Town's Waterfront was one thing at a million dollars but the hiring of garish yellow Lamborghinis and gold Rolls Royces to transport people who call themselves 'vips' from hotels to cricket grounds does not sit easy in the South African conscience.

Neither does making your South African personal security guard carry a suitcase with R480,000 (\$54,113) in cash for a shopping spree around the Waterfront's boutiques. Do India's mega-wealthy not carry credit cards?

There is a crime problem in this country. Most citizens try to employ as much common sense as possible to avoid becoming victims. But an awareness of the "real" world and an appreciation of "common sense" appear to

be in short supply at the moment.

Donations during each game to children's education are welcome and it seems churlish to question the integrity of the gesture. But just to put things in perspective, consider this: The entire education "scholarship" budget is, depending on which press release you read from which of the 100-plus PR people of the IPL, between R8 and R9 million. Roughly the same cost as the crayfish and champagne-laden launch party. (Just for curiosity's sake, what is \$900,000—as a percentage—out of a projected IPL turnover of \$2.4 billion?)

So desperate was the IPL for some charitable legitimisation, and so rushed was the subsequent education scheme, that the marketers most inspired scheme was to "choose five learners at random from the crowd"

and give them R15,000 (\$1,687) each to "pay for a year's education." And it really was "random", too, as two children who attended the R50,000-a-year (\$ 5,627) Hout Bay International School in Cape Town discovered.

In addition, the IPL said it would donate R100,000 (\$112,468) each to 32 previously disadvantaged schools close to the eight IPL venues. Former Springbok rugby captain, Francois Pienaar, is now a high-profile marketing man who was quickly snapped up by Lalit Modi to work the IPL account. He announced last week on live television that the IPL was "proud to leave a lasting legacy in South Africa."

Nice idea, but it takes a lot more than handing over cheques to leave a legacy of any kind. The IPL even admitted in its press release that they had no idea where or how the money